

Cancel Culture and the Digital Revolution

Understanding Online Accountability in the Age of Social Media

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Before getting started...

1. Do you think cancel culture promotes accountability, or does it unfairly punish people for their mistakes?
2. How has social media changed the way society responds to offensive or harmful behavior?
3. Should there be limits to cancel culture, and if so, who should decide where those limits are?

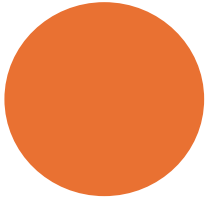
What is Cancel Culture?

- Public backlash or boycotting of a person or group
- Spread and amplified through social media platforms
- A tool for accountability when institutions fail to act
- Criticized for mob mentality and silencing others
- Reflects the power of digital communities to shape norms



Cancel Culture in Action

- When public boycotting and cancel culture takes place, it is normally due to controversial things someone did or said.
- A modern-day example of cancel culture in action -> Logan Paul.
- The Aokigahara or Japan forest video where Paul recorded a deceased individual sparked a massive public backlash leading to him being cancelled and boycotted by the public.
- Makes apology video.



Cancel Culture in Action

- Other notable celebs who have been cancelled consist of Ellen DeGeneres, Chris Brown, and James Charles.
- Cancel culture aims to make people take accountability and create a voice for the harmed groups.
- An example of a non-celeb who was cancelled -> Kyle Kashuv : Harvard scholarship rescinded after racist messages from his past resurfaced.
- Sadly, it is not always accurate and rumors and out-of-context clips can spread faster than truth.
- The public can also be rash, handing out punishments that don't always fit.



Social Media's Role

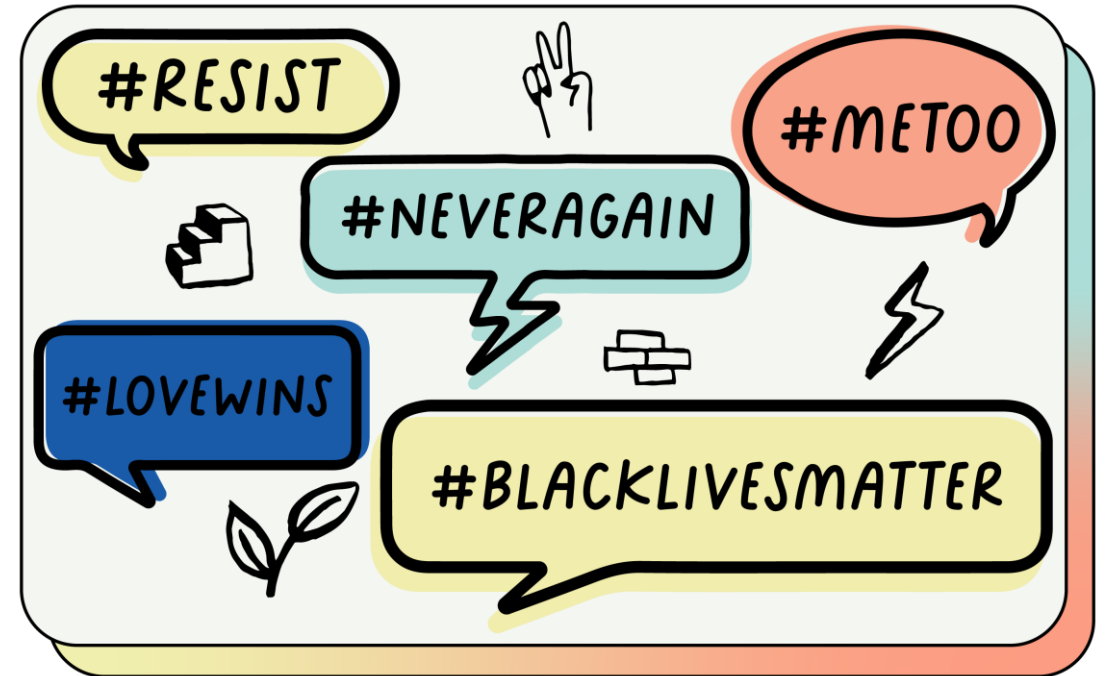
How should employers respond to public pressure from social media?

- Spread and Reach: One post can hit millions in minutes
- Algorithm: Drama and outrage gets pushed to the top
- Content Collapses: Statements go viral without background
- Receipts: Screenshots make posts permanent
- Platforms make it easy to mobilize
- Viral Clips can mislead



Pros of Cancel Culture

- Promotes accountability for harmful actions
- Amplifies marginalized voices and issues
- Encourages social awareness and responsibility
- Provides a form of grassroots justice when institutions fail
- Can lead to positive social change



Cons of Cancel Culture

- Can turn into online harassment or bullying
- Often lacks due process or context
- Creates fear of speaking out (self-censorship)
- Can ruin reputations permanently even for small mistakes
- Encourages mob mentality



Finding Balance

- Hold people accountable without harassment
- Encourage dialogue and education
- Consider intent, context, and growth



Redefining Accountability

Accountability shouldn't mean permanent punishment or social exile. It should mean acknowledging harm, learning, and improving.

- Encourage constructive conversations
- Differentiate accountability from harassment
- Build healthier online culture
- Encourage growth and redemption



Video



Kahoot

- [Cancel Culture Presentation - Kahoot!](#)